

Burden budget worksheet

- 1) System action
- 2) Worst-case error
- 3) Who experiences harm
 - Role:
 - Role:
- 4) Forms of burden
 - Role | Type | Min / Likely / Max (unit) | Assumptions
- 5) Estimated burden totals (optional)
 - Role | Time (hours) | Money (\$) | Delay (days) | Cognitive (1-5) | Humiliation (1-5) | Risk (1-5 + rationale)
- 6) Who absorbs the burden
 - Role | Type | Absorber | Notes
- 7) Maximum acceptable burden
 - Role | Type | Threshold (unit) | Condition
- 8) Enforcement trigger
 - Role | Threshold condition | Mandated action | Action owner | Timeframe
- 9) Repair pathway
 - Entry points:
 - Required documents:
 - Promised turnaround:
 - Interim protections:
- 10) Owner + review cadence
 - Owner:
 - Review cadence:
- 11) Deployer-side cost of governability

The mirror of sections 4-6: what the deploying institution pays to hold the burden it would otherwise transfer. A deployment whose denial economics only clear because contestation, reversal, and discovery are free to the operator is not efficient; it is subsidized by whoever cannot appeal.

Cost line	Basis	Estimate	Measu
red or		(unit)	assum
ed			

Human baseline it replaces (the labor the automation displaces, priced honestly)			

Contestation capacity (staffing, clocks, remedy SLAs)

Reversal capacity (safe-state fallbacks, rehearsals, downstream unwind)

Discovery duty (differential impact measurement, STD-06 §2.4)

Burden-reduction duty (AW-01: measured burden implies allocated remediation)

Liability held (premium or reserve against the carve-outs recorded on the grant)

- Automation's claimed saving vs. the cost lines above:
- Which cost lines, if unfunded, shift burden back onto sections 4-6:

Assumptions

Revision history

- Version | Revision | Date | Summary
- 1.1.0 | Added section 11, deployer-side cost of governability | 2026-09-11 | Prices the contestation, reversal, discovery, and liability costs a deployment must carry itself instead of transferring to affected parties.